CLASS NOTES · TADABBUR SIRI 13

Surah *Al-Ma'un*

Thursday, 17 September 2026 | Surah ke-107 · 7 ayat · Makkiyyah (majority view) | *Al-Ma'un* = the small kindness

IN SHORT

- Denying the akhirah shows in how we treat orphans and the poor.
- The threat is to those who **do** pray, but carelessly and to be seen.
- Even holding back small kindnesses is a sign of a weak deen.

1. Text & meaning

أَرَأَيْتَ الَّذِي يُكَذِّبُ بِالدِّينِ ﴿١﴾ فَذَٰلِكَ الَّذِي يَدُعُّ الْيَتِيمَ ﴿٢﴾ وَلَا يَحُضُّ عَلَىٰ طَعَامِ الْمِسْكِينِ ﴿٣﴾ فَوَيْلٌ لِّلْمُصَلِّينَ ﴿٤﴾ الَّذِينَ هُمْ عَن صَلَاتِهِمْ سَاهُونَ ﴿٥﴾ الَّذِينَ هُمْ يُرَاءُونَ ﴿٦﴾ وَيَمْنَعُونَ الْمَاعُونَ ﴿٧﴾

WORD BY WORD

1

أَرَأَيْتَ	الَّذِي	يُكَذِّبُ	بِالدِّينِ
tahukah engkau	orang yang	mendustakan	agama / hari pembalasan

Tahukah engkau (orang) yang mendustakan agama (hari pembalasan)?

2

فَذَٰلِكَ	الَّذِي	يَدُعُّ	الْيَتِيمَ
maka itulah	orang yang	menengking / menolak dengan kasar	anak yatim

Maka itulah orang yang menengking anak yatim,

3

وَلَا	يَحُضُّ	عَلَىٰ	طَعَامِ	الْمِسْكِينِ
dan tidak	menggalakkan	untuk	memberi makan	orang miskin

dan tidak menggalakkan memberi makan orang miskin.

4

فَوَيْلٌ	لِّلْمُصَلِّينَ
maka celakalah	bagi orang-orang yang solat

Maka celakalah bagi orang-orang yang solat,

5

الَّذِينَ	هُمْ	عَن	صَلَاتِهِمْ	سَاهُونَ
(iaitu) yang	mereka	daripada	solat mereka	lalai

(iaitu) mereka yang lalai daripada solatnya,

6

الَّذِينَ	هُمْ	يُرَاءُونَ
yang	mereka	riak (mahu dilihat)

orang-orang yang riak,

7

وَيَمْنَعُونَ	الْمَاعُونَ
dan mereka menghalang	bantuan / barang berguna

dan mereka menghalang (memberi) bantuan / barang berguna.

"Al-Ma'un" = useful things, anything that benefits — the small kindness. *The small things we hold back from others. Most scholars say the surah is Makkiyyah; some say ayat 1–3 are Makkiyyah and 4–7 Madaniyyah (about the hypocrites). It doesn't change the lesson.*

2. Two parts, one root cause

Ayat 1–3 = denying the Day of Judgement → broken akhlak towards people. Ayat 4–7 = solat that's there, but empty. The root of both is the same: **not being certain about the Day of Judgement**.

3. The damage of denying the akhirah

When someone doesn't believe in the akhirah, the damage isn't only to them — it spreads: no sympathy, no empathy, greed, hustle, selfishness, chasing only dunia.

> **Even those who *say* they believe may not really be certain — and it shows in how little they prepare.** When we plan to travel, what's our preparation? So for the akhirah, what's ours? **Where's our checklist?** Someone truly certain of the akhirah is willing to sacrifice dunia for it.

Yasin 36:78–79 — the disbelievers brought crumbled bones: *"Siapakah yang dapat menghidupkan tulang-belulang yang telah hancur?"* Allah answers: *"Katakanlah: Yang menghidupkannya ialah Tuhan yang menciptakannya kali pertama, dan Dia Maha Mengetahui setiap makhluk."*

DENYING ALLAH'S COMMANDS

To run a machine we need the manual. Same for understanding how this world works — **the Quran and Sunnah are the Book of Guidance**.

TERM	MEANING
Sunnah	What the Prophet ﷺ did, said, and approved by staying silent (*taqrir*)
Sunat	A ruling: do it and you're rewarded, leave it and there's no sin
Maqbul (accepted)	Sahih, hasan

Mardud (rejected)	Da'if (lightly or severely weak), maudhu' (fabricated)

4. Denial in words — and in deeds

Denying the deen isn't just in what we say — it shows in how we treat the **orphan** and the **poor**. An orphan (*yatim*) = (1) has lost their father, (2) hasn't reached baligh.

> *A man complained to the Prophet ﷺ about the hardness of his heart. He said: "Usaplah kepala anak yatim, dan berilah makan orang miskin."*
>
> MUSNAD AHMAD (ABU HURAIRAH) · ACCEPTED — AL-ALBANI, SAHIH AL-JAMI' 80; AL-SAN'ANI

The cure for a hard heart is **real, practical compassion** — not theory.

> *"Aku dan penjaga anak yatim di dalam syurga seperti ini" — and he ﷺ held up his index and middle fingers, slightly apart.*
>
> BUKHARI 5304, 6005 (SAHL BIN SA'D); MUSLIM 2983 (ABU HURAIRAH) · SAHIH

Be careful not to mix this up with the popular "one good deed for every hair on the orphan's head" narration — that one is da'if.

> **Musa & Khidir (Al-Kahf 18:71–82):** a boat damaged, a boy killed, a wall rebuilt. The wall was rebuilt to protect the treasure of two orphans — **because their father was righteous** (18:82). Be a believer, and Allah will look after us and our families.

Action: plan how we'll actually support these groups — not just feel sorry for them.

5. Ayat 4–7 — solat that's there, but empty

Notice: the threat isn't to people who **don't** pray — it's to *al-musallin*, **those who pray**. This is the ayat a believer should fear.

Wayl is a word of severe punishment and destruction. Some of the salaf explained it as a valley in Jahannam (this is reported from them, e.g. in at-Tabari's tafsir).

The hadith that says so (Tirmidhi 3164) is da'if, so it shouldn't be quoted as the Prophet's ﷺ words.

"Sahun" (lalai) — from class: heedlessness isn't only about the solat itself, but **everything around it**, before and after. It includes: rukuk, sujud and tuma'ninah done badly; delaying solat; men leaving the jemaah at the masjid; women being careless with their solat at home.

Al-Mu'minun 23:1–2 — "Sesungguhnya berjayalah orang-orang yang beriman, (iaitu) mereka yang khusyuk dalam solatnya." Khusyuk = the successful ones. Solat is guarded outside and inside.

AYAT 6 — RIAK

Showing your tears — why? Because you want people to see. There's no "winning" in front of Allah. If you want to compete, measure yourself against those who've already died: they can't add any more deeds, but we still can.

AYAT 7 — HOLDING BACK SMALL KINDNESSES

Withholding anything that could help someone. Small in people's eyes — but Allah mentions it as a sign of denying the deen.

6. The reward of reciting the Quran

> *"Dikatakan kepada pembaca Al-Quran: Bacalah dan naiklah, dan tartilkanlah sebagaimana engkau mentartilkannya di dunia — sesungguhnya kedudukanmu berada pada ayat terakhir yang engkau baca."*
>
> ABU DAWUD 1464; TIRMIDHI 2914 (ABDULLAH BIN 'AMR) · HASAN SAHIH

*The hadith speaks of **recitation** as the measure; understanding is still demanded, but it isn't the wording of this hadith.*

Reflections

- **This surah tests iman through behaviour, not theory.** How we treat orphans, whether we encourage feeding the poor, whether we share small things — these are where belief in the akhirah shows.
- **Ayat 3 condemns "not encouraging", not just "not giving".** Staying silent when we could nudge someone towards good is itself a failure.
- **Where's our akhirah checklist?** We plan trips in detail. The one journey that's certain is the one we leave the least prepared for.

Personal notes from the 17/9/2026 class, compiled for revision and sharing. All ayat and hadith checked against quran.com, sunnah.com and dorar.net. Any mistakes are mine — please tegur. والله أعلم